

VER. 2025.03

Authenticity

Helmet - Klappvisors

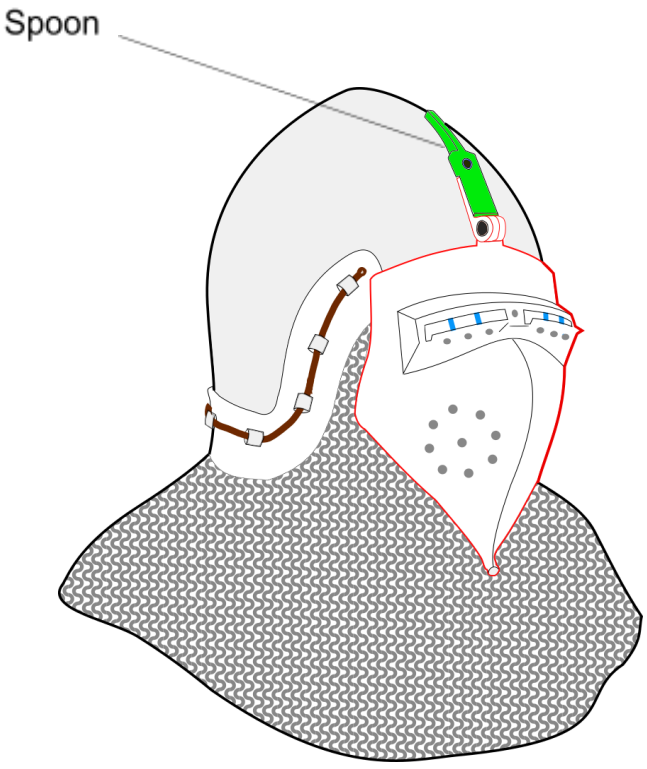
Helmet Klappvisors

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1. Definition

- Klappvisor Bascinet is a medieval helmet that originated in the 14th century. "Klappvisor" is German and translates to "folding visor." The single brow-mounted hinge is a distinctive feature of early bascinet visor designs. These bascinet visors were often low profile to fit underneath a great helm, but would also serve as a primary defense on their own.
- Klappvisor uses a solid metal visor to protect the face, attached on the forehead by a piece of metal, the “spoon”.
- Klappvisor was used from 1340 to 1400, mainly in Germany and Italy.
- Klappvisor is **approved** for 14th century and Transitional armors.
- Klappvisor is **denied** for 15th century armors.



2. Historical sources and datation

2.1 German-Style Klappvisors



A



B



C



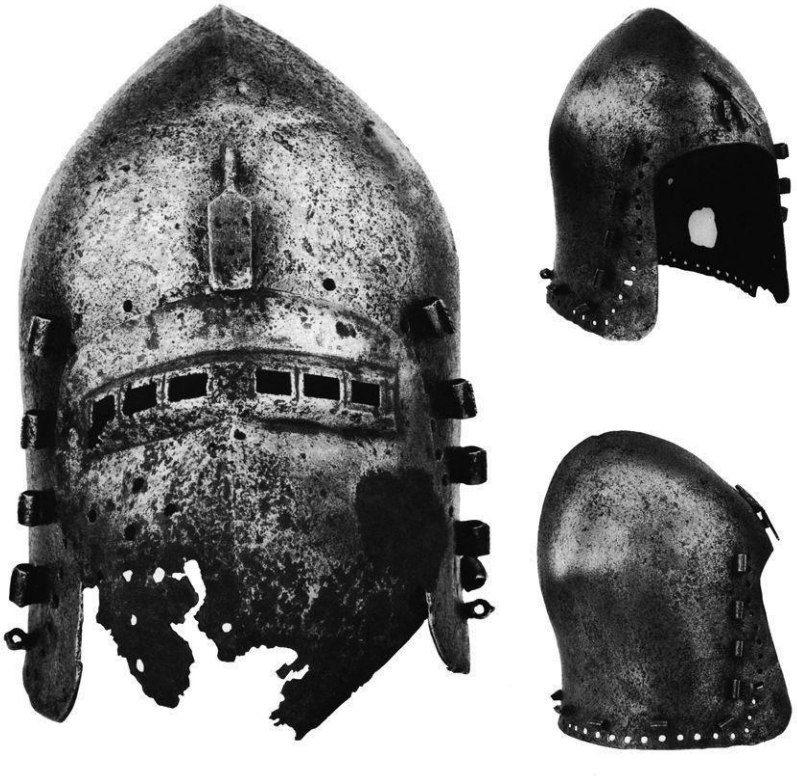
D

A:“Sitten Klappvisor” - 1390 - Switzerland, Picture from Musées cantonaux du Valais, Sion(Jean-Yves Glassey, Martigny) ©

B: “Bavarian Klappvisor” - unknown datation, probably late 14th cent.- Bavarian Army Museum, Munich, Germany

C: Nuremberg Museum - 1370/1380 - Germany

D: Coburg helmet - 1380/1390 - Germany



Berlin Museum - 1350 - Germany

2.2 Italian style Klappvisor



A



B



C

A: 14th century (datation unknown) - Italy

B: 1350 - Italy

C: Milan Klappvisor, Museo Stibbert,1390/1400 - Italy

2.3 Other style Klappvisor



1375 - Netherlands



Leeds Armouries - 1350/1380 - England

3. Requirements

3.1 General Requirements

- Reproductions must closely resemble the appearance and proportions of a Klappvisor source.
- Any metal part of the helmet must conform to the Armors and weapons Aesthetics and decorations document.
- Any textile or leather part of the helmet must conform to the Textiles and Leather document.

3.2 Visor Requirements

- Visor must not be too long or too short, it must respect the proportions of historical sources.
- The hinge must be reproduced as per historical sources.
- It is allowed to weld the hinge. Welded hinges must resemble a functional hinge.
- It is allowed to weld the visor down. Welded visor must resemble a functional removable visor.
- It is allowed to add a metal plate to protect the throat. Such a plate must be strong enough to endure full contact fight and must be concealed under the aventail.
- A leather strap can be used to secure the visor down.
- Breath holes should be round and must not exceed a diameter of 10mm. Breath holes must not be so numerous that they compromise the helm's structural integrity. It is acceptable to mirror breath holes to both sides.
- Breath holes of another shape must be documented by historical sources to be allowed.

3.3 Eye-slots

- Eye slots should resemble sources for the visor.
- Eye slots should not exceed 25mm tall to prevent any injury.
- Klappvisor with 2 eye slots are allowed to add up to two (2) safety eye bars per eye slot.
- Klappvisor may have integrated Eye bars. Such eye bars must be made accordingly with historical sources, in terms of proportion, numbers and aesthetic.
- Eye bars must conform to the Eye bars rules document.

3.4 Aventail

- Klappvisors must be worn with chainmail aventails, fabric aventails, or scales aventails.
- Aventails must conform to the Aventails document.
- Aventails must be attached to the bascinet by a system of leather and vervelles.

- The aventail must be fastened down to the edge of a padded pelerine attached to the helmet liner.
- Protective plates covering the cervical spine must be hidden under the aventail.

3.5 Others

- Klappvisors may be decorated in the spirit of medieval styles, such as orle, torse, decorated aventails (with cooper/brass chainmail rings), vervelle covers and coat of arms badges etc.
- Such decoration must be made in coherence with historical sources.
- Using modern and/or offensive imagery and slogans is prohibited.

4. Approved Reproductions





Pictures from The Medieval Things ©







Pictures from Medieval Extreme ©

5. Denied Reproductions



Integrated eye bars out of historical proportions



Visor not based on historical sources

+ incomplete aventail

Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

6. Changelog

Below, we will keep track of all the changes made over the lifetime of this document. This way, all our members can see how the documents are changing over time.

March-2025:

Formatting: Grammar and Formatting

Add: 3.3 Klappvisor may have integrated Eye bars. Such eye bars must be made accordingly with historical sources, in terms of proportion, numbers and aesthetic.

11-Nov-2024: -Add
Document has been created